Tutorial IV.II - Variables and Bounds in JuMP

Applied Optimization with Julia



Introduction

Welcome to this beginner-friendly tutorial on variables and bounds in JuMP! In this lesson, we'll explore different types of variables and how to set limits (or bounds) on them. Don't worry if you're new to optimization - we'll explain everything step by step using real-world examples.

Follow the instructions, write your code in the designated code blocks, and confirm your understanding with `@assert` statements. Make sure to have the JuMP package installed to follow this tutorial.

By the end of this tutorial, you'll be able to:

1. Create continuous, integer, and binary variables
2. Group many similar variables in containers like arrays and matrices
3. Set and change lower and upper bounds on variables

Let's start by loading the JuMP package:

```
using JuMP
```

Now, let's create a model that we'll use throughout this tutorial:

```
model = Model()
println("Great! We've created a new optimization model.")
```

```
Great! We've created a new optimization model.
```

> **Note**
> In the last tutorial, we wrote `Model(HiGHS.Optimizer)` to tell JuMP which solver to use. Here we write `Model()` without a solver, because in this tutorial we only create variables and never solve the model. If you want to solve a model later, you can still attach a solver with `set_optimizer(model, HiGHS.Optimizer)`.

Section 1 - Understanding Different Types of Variables

In optimization problems, we often need to represent different kinds of decisions. JuMP allows us to use three main types of variables:

1. **Continuous variables**: These can take any real value within a range. Example: The amount of water in a bottle (can be any number, like 0.7 liters).
2. **Integer variables**: These can only be whole numbers. Example: The number of cars produced in a factory (we can't produce half a car!).
3. **Binary variables**: These can only be 0 or 1. Example: Whether to build a new store in a location (yes = 1, no = 0).

Let's see how to create each type:

```
@variable(model, variableName)
```

This defines a continuous variable without any bound.

```
@variable(model, 0 <= variableName2 <= 1)
has_lower_bound(variableName2) && has_upper_bound(variableName2)
```

This defines a continuous variable in an interval.

```
@variable(model, variableName3, Bin)
is_binary(variableName3)
```

This defines a binary variable.

```
@variable(model, 0 <= variableName4, Int)
is_integer(variableName4)
```

This defines an integer variable.

> **Note**
> Note that you will have to change `model` and `variableName` according to your instance.

Exercise 1.1 - Create Variables

Now it's your turn! Create three variables:

1. A continuous variable called `water_amount`
2. An integer variable called `cars_produced`
3. A binary variable called `build_store`

```
# YOUR CODE BELOW
# Hint: Use the @variable macro three times, once for each variable


# Test your answer
@assert typeof(water_amount) == VariableRef && !is_integer(water_amount) && !
is_binary(water_amount)
@assert typeof(cars_produced) == VariableRef && is_integer(cars_produced)
@assert typeof(build_store) == VariableRef && is_binary(build_store)
@assert is_valid(model, water_amount) && is_valid(model, cars_produced) &&
```

```
is_valid(model, build_store)
println("Excellent work! You've successfully created continuous, integer, and
binary variables.")
```

Section 2 - Creating Variables in Containers

When we have many similar variables, it's helpful to group them together. JuMP allows us to use containers like arrays and matrices for this purpose. For example:

```
@variable(model, variableName5[1:20], Bin)
```

```
20-element Vector{VariableRef}:
 variableName5[1]
 variableName5[2]
 variableName5[3]
 variableName5[4]
 variableName5[5]
 variableName5[6]
 variableName5[7]
 variableName5[8]
 variableName5[9]
 variableName5[10]
 variableName5[11]
 variableName5[12]
 variableName5[13]
 variableName5[14]
 variableName5[15]
 variableName5[16]
 variableName5[17]
 variableName5[18]
 variableName5[19]
 variableName5[20]
```

This would create a container with 20 variables. To create a container indexed by a range, we could do:

```
new_range = 1:100
@variable(model, variableName6[i in new_range] >= 0)
```

```
1-dimensional DenseAxisArray{JuMP.VariableRef,1,...} with index sets:
    Dimension 1, 1:100
And data, a 100-element Vector{JuMP.VariableRef}:
 variableName6[1]
 variableName6[2]
 variableName6[3]
```

```
 variableName6[4]
 variableName6[5]
 variableName6[6]
 variableName6[7]
 variableName6[8]
 variableName6[9]
 variableName6[10]
 ⋮
 variableName6[92]
 variableName6[93]
 variableName6[94]
 variableName6[95]
 variableName6[96]
 variableName6[97]
 variableName6[98]
 variableName6[99]
 variableName6[100]
```

This would create a container with 100 continuous variables larger than 0. For a container with multiple dimensions:

```
@variable(model, variableName7[1:30, 1:30])
```

```
30×30 Matrix{VariableRef}:
 variableName7[1,1]   variableName7[1,2]   …  variableName7[1,30]
 variableName7[2,1]   variableName7[2,2]      variableName7[2,30]
 variableName7[3,1]   variableName7[3,2]      variableName7[3,30]
 variableName7[4,1]   variableName7[4,2]      variableName7[4,30]
 variableName7[5,1]   variableName7[5,2]      variableName7[5,30]
 variableName7[6,1]   variableName7[6,2]   …  variableName7[6,30]
 variableName7[7,1]   variableName7[7,2]      variableName7[7,30]
 variableName7[8,1]   variableName7[8,2]      variableName7[8,30]
 variableName7[9,1]   variableName7[9,2]      variableName7[9,30]
 variableName7[10,1]  variableName7[10,2]     variableName7[10,30]
 ⋮                                         ⋱
 variableName7[22,1]  variableName7[22,2]     variableName7[22,30]
 variableName7[23,1]  variableName7[23,2]     variableName7[23,30]
 variableName7[24,1]  variableName7[24,2]     variableName7[24,30]
 variableName7[25,1]  variableName7[25,2]     variableName7[25,30]
 variableName7[26,1]  variableName7[26,2]  …  variableName7[26,30]
 variableName7[27,1]  variableName7[27,2]     variableName7[27,30]
 variableName7[28,1]  variableName7[28,2]     variableName7[28,30]
 variableName7[29,1]  variableName7[29,2]     variableName7[29,30]
 variableName7[30,1]  variableName7[30,2]     variableName7[30,30]
```

This would create a container with a matrix of continuous variables without any bound. Note that you will have to change `model` and `variableName` according to your instance.

> **Note**
> The three examples above together added more than 1000 variables to our shared `model`. That's no problem here, as we never solve this model - but don't be surprised if you inspect `model` and find it quite full.

Exercise 2.1 - Create an Array

Imagine you're planning production for a week. Create an array `daily_production` with 7 non-negative variables, one for each day of the week.

```
# YOUR CODE BELOW


# Test your answer
@assert length(daily_production) == 7
@assert all(lower_bound(daily_production[i]) == 0 for i in 1:7)
@assert all(is_valid(model, daily_production[i]) for i in 1:7)
println("Great job! You've created an array of 7 non-negative variables for
daily production.")
```

Exercise 2.2 - Create a Matrix of Variables

Now, imagine you're deciding whether to stock 4 different products in 3 different stores. Create a 3x4 matrix of binary variables called `stock_decision`.

```
# YOUR CODE BELOW


# Test your answer
@assert size(stock_decision) == (3, 4)
@assert all(is_binary(stock_decision[i,j]) for i in 1:3, j in 1:4)
@assert all(is_valid(model, stock_decision[i,j]) for i in 1:3, j in 1:4)
println("Excellent! You've created a 3x4 matrix of binary variables for
stocking decisions.")
```

Matrices of variables like this one are the backbone of many optimization models. For example, the transportation problem in Tutorial IV.V uses exactly this shape to decide how much to ship from each supplier to each customer.

Section 3 - Setting Bounds on Variables

Often, we know that a variable can't go below or above certain values. We can set these limits (called bounds) when we create the variable.

For example, if a factory can produce between 100 and 500 units:

```
@variable(model, 100 <= production <= 500)
```

Or if we know a percentage must be between 0 and 100:

```
@variable(model, 0 <= percentage <= 100)
```

We can also change the bounds of a variable after it has been created:

```
@variable(model, 100 <= production <= 500)
set_lower_bound(production, 50)     # Lower the minimum to 50
set_upper_bound(production, 600)    # Raise the maximum to 600
delete_lower_bound(production)      # Remove the lower bound entirely
```

Exercise 3.1 - Set Bounds on a Variable

Create a variable `temperature` that represents the temperature setting on a thermostat. It should be between 0 and 37 degrees Celsius. The test checks both the lower and the upper bound, so set both at once using the interval syntax `lower <= variable <= upper` from the examples above.

```
# YOUR CODE BELOW


# Test your answer
@assert is_valid(model, temperature)
@assert lower_bound(temperature) == 0
@assert upper_bound(temperature) == 37
println("Well done! You've created a variable for temperature with appropriate
bounds.")
```

Conclusion

Fantastic! You've completed the tutorial on variables and bounds in JuMP. You've learned how to create continuous, integer, and binary variables, how to group many variables in containers like arrays and matrices, and how to set and change bounds on variables. Continue to the next file to learn more.

Solutions

You will likely find solutions to most exercises online. However, I strongly encourage you to work on these exercises independently without searching explicitly for the exact answers to the exercises. Understanding someone else's solution is very different from developing your own. Use the lecture notes and try to solve the exercises on your own. This approach will significantly enhance your learning and problem-solving skills.

Remember, the goal is not just to complete the exercises, but to understand the concepts and improve your programming abilities. If you encounter difficulties, review the lecture materials, experiment with different approaches, and don't hesitate to ask for clarification during class discussions.

Bibliography